



MARKETS

A Stellar Debut

The TAC Infosec IPO saw bids worth ₹8,417.33 crore pouring in, thanks to intense bidding from all categories of investors

BY ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

► **THE PAST COUPLE** of years have seen many public issues of SMEs (small and medium-sized enterprises) generating a lot of buzz due to their overwhelming oversubscription and listing gains, and the recent past has been no different. But one significant distinction emerged last month. Cybersecurity firm TAC Infosec saw marquee names such as Bank of America Securities and UBS buying shares of the company from the secondary market within a week after its stellar debut on the bourses—an unprecedented occurrence for the SME segment in recent times.

The company, which is backed by well-known stock market investor Vijay Kedia and has offices in Chandigarh, Mumbai, and Bengaluru in India, as well as in San Francisco and Albuquerque in the US, made its debut on the SME platform of the National Stock Exchange

BUMPER LISTING

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(NSE) on April 5, with its shares getting listed at ₹290, much higher than the issue price of ₹106. On its debut, each lot of TAC Infosec, consisting of 1,200 equity shares, delivered a profit of nearly ₹2.21 lakh to the investors. The SME IPO, valued at ₹29.99 crore, received bids worth ₹8,417.33 crore, thanks to intense bidding from all categories of investors; the retail portion was subscribed 433.54 times.

Trishneet Arora, Founder & CEO of TAC Infosec, attributes the IPO's success to a combination of factors, including the strong outlook for the cybersecurity sector, and its mix of marquee clients in the domestic and international arena, including NPCI, BSE, and Google. "Cybersecurity is the need of the hour, and the response to our IPO is not only about our company but also a recognition of the strong outlook for the sector as well," says Arora.

Interestingly, the company's shares managed to maintain their post-listing levels and closed at ₹286.90 on April 17, gaining 2.17% even though the benchmark Nifty 50 ended in the red.

"I think our story is genuinely a part of the India growth story, the digital story, and also the start-up story. I am very optimistic about our growth outlook, as the Indian cybersecurity market, which is currently around \$2 billion in size, is expected to grow to \$10 billion in the next few years," says Arora. **BT**

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